Claude Certified Architect Foundations

(CCAR-F)

Practice Exam
Question Set

60 scenario-based questions · answers and rationales included

Written by someone who sat and passed the exam

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About this set

I passed the Claude Certified Architect – Foundations exam, and the thing that surprised me most was how close the answer options are. Many questions have four options that all sound reasonable, and the task is to pick the one that is *most* correct for the stated production context. A wrong answer is usually still a sensible idea. It just doesn't fix the root cause, or it relies on the model following a prompt where the situation needs a guarantee in code.

This set is written to train that judgment. It has 60 original questions, ten for each of the six scenarios in the public exam guide. Most items describe something that has already gone wrong in production and ask for the fix that addresses the cause. 11 of the questions ask you to select two answers.

Questions by domain

Domain	Topic	Questions
Domain 1	Agentic Architecture & Orchestration	16
Domain 2	Tool Design & MCP Integration	11
Domain 3	Claude Code Configuration & Workflows	12
Domain 4	Prompt Engineering & Structured Output	12
Domain 5	Context Management & Reliability	9
	Total	**60**

How to use it

- Answer a whole scenario before you check anything. The answer key with rationales starts after Scenario 6.
- Every question is tagged with its domain, so you can score yourself by domain and see where you are weak.
- Read the rationale even when you got the question right. The explanations of why the other options fail are where most of the learning is.
- When two options both look right, ask which one is deterministic, which one fixes the cause rather than the symptom, and which one fits the scale described.

> **Please note.** These are original practice questions written against the publicly available exam guide and its objectives. They are not questions from the live exam. Answers about product behaviour were checked against the official Claude and Claude Code documentation as of October 2026. Features change, so verify against the current docs if something looks different. This is an independent study resource and is not affiliated with or endorsed by Anthropic.

SCENARIO 1

Customer Support Resolution Agent

You are building a customer support resolution agent with the Claude Agent SDK. It handles high-ambiguity requests (returns, billing disputes, account issues) via custom MCP tools (get_customer, lookup_order, process_refund, escalate_to_human) targeting 80%+ first-contact resolution while knowing when to escalate.

Question 1.1 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

Audit logs show that 7% of refunds last month were issued against a customer ID that appeared in the user's own message but was not returned by get_customer. The agent's system prompt already says to verify identity first. Which change most reliably prevents this class of incident?

A. Expand the system prompt to explain the audit finding and state that any customer ID passed to process_refund must have been returned by get_customer earlier in the same conversation.

B. Add four few-shot examples in which users volunteer a customer ID and the agent still calls get_customer first and then uses the ID that the tool returns.

C. Track the customer ID returned by get_customer and intercept process_refund and lookup_order calls, rejecting any call whose ID differs and telling the agent to verify first.

D. Force get_customer with tool_choice on the first turn of every conversation so that verification happens before any other tool call is made.

Question 1.2 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 2

lookup_order returns the same isError response with the text 'Search failed' in two situations: the order service times out, and a valid search matches no orders. The agent retries both five times and then tells customers the system is down, even when the order simply does not exist. What is the best redesign?

A. Return a successful result with zero matches when the search ran, and return a transient, retryable error describing what was attempted when the service times out.

B. Keep isError for both cases but give each a distinct message string, and add system prompt guidance listing which message strings mean retry and which mean stop retrying and tell the customer.

C. Reduce the retry limit from five to one for every error type, so customers see a fallback message sooner and less time is spent on repeated calls to the service.

D. Mark both situations as business errors with retriable false and a customer-friendly explanation, so the agent stops retrying and escalates the case to a human.

Question 1.3 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 5

get_customer returns three records for 'Maria Gonzalez'. The customer, visibly annoyed, writes: 'Just look me up, I do not have time for questions.' Escalation volume is already above target. What should the agent do?

A. Select the record with the most recent order, since recency is a strong signal, and confirm the choice by reading that order back to the customer.

B. Escalate to a human immediately, because multiple matches combined with a frustrated customer indicate a case beyond the agent's capability.

C. Have the agent estimate its confidence for each candidate record and proceed with the highest one, escalating when that confidence is below 7 out of 10.

D. Acknowledge the frustration briefly and ask for one additional identifier, such as the email address or an order number, before any account action.

Question 1.4 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

Three MCP tools return dates in different forms (Unix seconds, ISO 8601 strings, and a numeric status code such as 2 for 'shipped'), and the agent occasionally misorders events and misreads status. Separately, policy requires human review for refunds above $500. Which hook design covers both needs?

A. One PostToolUse hook that normalizes the formats and also checks the refund amount once process_refund returns, escalating to a human reviewer whenever the amount exceeds the $500 limit.

B. A PostToolUse hook that converts timestamps and status codes to one format before the model sees them, plus a hook on outgoing process_refund calls that blocks amounts above $500 and escalates.

C. A hook on outgoing calls that rewrites tool arguments into one date format, plus the $500 rule written into the process_refund tool description for the model to follow when it decides.

D. System prompt sections that document every tool's date and status conventions and state the $500 limit, reviewed each month against the tools' actual behavior and output.

Question 1.5 · Multiple response · Select TWO Domain 2

process_refund returns isError true with the text 'Refund rejected' both for a request outside the 30-day return window and for a payment gateway timeout. The agent retries both and then tells customers there is a technical problem. Which TWO changes fix this? (Select TWO.)

A. For the policy violation, return retriable false with a customer-friendly explanation of the 30-day window that the agent can relay.

B. Return the raw gateway status code and stack trace for every failure, so the agent can diagnose the cause on its own.

C. For the gateway timeout, return error category transient with isRetryable true, so retries go to failures that can succeed.

D. List the possible rejection strings and their meanings in the system prompt, so the agent can interpret the text of each error message.

E. Lower the retry limit to one attempt for all errors, which reduces wasted calls without changing the tool's responses.

Question 1.6 · Multiple choice · Select ONE

Domain 1

A support agent runs a hard-coded sequence of get_customer, lookup_order, then process_refund on every request. About 40% of tickets are account-access problems with no order, and each new issue type needs another branch added to the sequence. What is the best direction?

A. Run a loop where Claude picks each next tool from accumulated results while stop_reason is tool_use, with identity verification kept as a programmatic prerequisite.

B. Extend the decision tree with a branch for each new ticket type, so every category has a tested, predictable sequence of tool calls and nothing is left to model judgment.

C. Keep the fixed sequence but add a classifier that skips steps when the ticket type indicates a step is not needed, so account-access tickets bypass the order lookup.

D. Ask Claude to produce the complete tool sequence in a single response, then execute that sequence step by step without returning to the model between the individual steps.

Question 1.7 · Multiple choice · Select ONE

Domain 5

A session covers a damaged-item refund of $212.40 on order #A, an address change on order #B, and a missing loyalty credit. After the history was summarized at turn 20, the agent applied the refund amount to the loyalty credit discussion and mixed up the order numbers. What is the best fix?

A. Raise the summarization threshold so the history is condensed later in the conversation, which reduces how often details are compressed into summary text.

B. Instruct the summarizer to preserve all numbers and order IDs, and review a sample of summaries every week to catch details that were lost.

C. Remove summarization and keep complete tool outputs for the whole session, so that no detail is lost as the conversation keeps growing longer.

D. Keep a structured record per issue (order ID, amount, status) in a separate context layer sent with every prompt, outside the summarized history.

Question 1.8 · Multiple choice · Select ONE

Domain 2

The support agent has 18 tools covering support, billing analytics, and admin functions. Tool selection errors rose after the last two tools were added, even though every description is detailed. What is the most effective change?

A. Keep all 18 tools and extend each description with more example queries, edge cases, and boundary statements about similar tools.

B. Give the agent the 4 or 5 tools that the support role needs, and move analytics and admin tools to agents with those roles.

C. Set tool_choice to any so the model must call a tool on every turn rather than replying with conversational text.

D. Merge the 18 tools into six broad tools that take an action parameter, which reduces the number of choices the model sees.

Question 1.9 · Multiple response · Select TWO Domain 1

A customer reports a duplicate charge of $86.50 on order #5521 and an account lockout that only a human can clear. The human team cannot see the conversation transcript. Which TWO behaviors are correct? (Select TWO.)

A. Escalate the entire conversation immediately, because one of the two issues requires a human and the human team can handle both issues together.

B. Investigate and resolve the refund, which is within the agent's authority, and reply with one message that covers both items.

C. Paste the last 20 raw messages into the escalation note so that no detail from the conversation is lost for the human team.

D. Resolve the lockout first, then ask the customer to resend the refund request as a separate message once the lockout is cleared.

E. Escalate the lockout with a structured summary: customer ID, root cause analysis, refund amount, and recommended action.

Question 1.10 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 2

After a prompt update added the rule 'When a message mentions an account, follow the account verification workflow', the agent began calling get_customer for order questions such as 'my account shows order #4471 missing'. The tool descriptions are detailed and were not changed. What is the best next step?

A. Add more example queries to the lookup_order description, since that tool is now being outcompeted by get_customer for order questions.

B. Add five few-shot examples of order questions that mention the word account and are correctly routed to lookup_order.

C. Reword the new rule around intent, such as verifying identity before account-changing operations, then re-test the ambiguous queries.

D. Place a routing layer in front of the agent that picks the tool from the identifier pattern found in each incoming message.

SCENARIO 2

Code Generation with Claude Code

Your team uses Claude Code for code generation, refactoring, debugging, and documentation, integrated into daily development with custom slash commands and CLAUDE.md configuration, and you must judge when plan mode beats direct execution.

Question 2.1 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 3

Claude ignores the API conventions in packages/api for several developers. The conventions live in docs/api-standards.md, and the root CLAUDE.md mentions that path in plain text without importing it. What is the best diagnosis and fix?

A. Copy the full contents of docs/api-standards.md into the root CLAUDE.md so that every package in the repository receives the conventions.

B. Ask each developer to add the conventions to their own ~/.claude/CLAUDE.md, where they will load in every session on that machine.

C. Convert docs/api-standards.md into a skill, so the conventions are available whenever a developer works on the API package.

D. Use /context to confirm which memory files are loaded, then add an @import for docs/api-standards.md to the CLAUDE.md in packages/api.

Question 2.2 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 3

Storybook files named *.stories.tsx are spread across 30 component folders under packages/ui and apps/. They need conventions that no other file needs, and the team wants those tokens loaded only when such files are edited. What is the most maintainable setup?

A. Add a CLAUDE.md to each of the 30 folders that contain stories, each holding the same Storybook conventions, and keep the copies in sync as the rules change.

B. Create a .claude/rules/ file whose paths field holds a glob such as **/*.stories.tsx, so the rules load when matching files are edited.

C. Add a Storybook section to the root CLAUDE.md, so every session has the conventions available whenever they are needed.

D. Create a skill with context fork that contains the conventions, and invoke it manually before editing any story file.

Question 2.3 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 3

A /analyze-codebase skill dumps thousands of lines of exploration output into the main conversation, and one run edited a file during analysis. The team wants the skill to keep its output out of the main session and to be unable to modify files. Which frontmatter configuration achieves both?

A. context: fork together with agent set to a read-only subagent type, such as Explore, so the forked run has no write tools.

B. allowed-tools limited to Read, Grep, and Glob, which both restricts the tools and keeps the verbose output out of the main conversation.

C. context: fork on its own, because an isolated context also prevents the skill from writing to files in the repository.

D. An argument-hint describing the target directory, so that the skill examines a smaller part of the codebase on each run.

Question 2.4 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 5

Three hours into mapping a 2,000-file legacy system, Claude starts answering with 'typical repository patterns' rather than naming the LegacyInvoiceBatcher class it found earlier. You must continue for several more hours across three more subsystems. What should you do?

A. Ask Claude to re-read the earlier files whenever a question touches them, so that its answers are grounded in the actual code again each time.

B. Switch to a model with a larger context window, so that the session no longer degrades as it continues running for several more hours.

C. Have Claude record key findings in a scratchpad file, delegate verbose probing to subagents, and run /compact as discovery output accumulates.

D. Add a CLAUDE.md instruction telling Claude to cite specific classes instead of typical patterns whenever it answers questions about the system.

Question 2.5 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 3

Four tasks are queued: (1) fix a null-pointer error in one function with a clear stack trace, (2) migrate a date library across 45 files, (3) add a date-format check to one validator, and (4) choose between webhooks and polling for a new integration, where the two need different infrastructure. Which plan of action is best?

A. Use plan mode for all four tasks, because the cost of planning is small compared with the cost of rework when a hidden dependency appears.

B. Use direct execution for all four tasks and switch to plan mode only if tests begin to fail along the way.

C. Use plan mode for tasks 1 and 2, and direct execution for tasks 3 and 4, since task 4 is a decision rather than a code change.

D. Use plan mode for tasks 2 and 4, direct execution for tasks 1 and 3, and implement the migration directly once its plan is settled.

Question 2.6 · Multiple response · Select TWO Domain 3

A migration script handles null values and timezone conversion inconsistently. Three prose descriptions of the desired behavior have produced three different results, and fixing the null handling changes how timezones are treated. Which TWO approaches are most effective? (Select TWO.)

A. Restate the prose requirements more emphatically in the next message, with the key rules written in capital letters and repeated twice.

B. Report the null-handling problem now and the timezone problem in a later message, so each fix can be verified in isolation.

C. Provide two or three concrete input and expected output examples, including one with a null value, to pin down the transformation.

D. Ask Claude to implement the script fully first, then write tests afterward to confirm that the behavior is correct.

E. Describe both problems together in one detailed message, because the fixes interact and need to be reasoned about at once.

Question 2.7 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

On Monday you built a named session, payments-investigation, analyzing 40 files. By Wednesday, teammates merged changes touching 3 of those files. You need to continue the investigation. What is the best approach?

A. Resume payments-investigation and continue directly, since the session retained everything it learned about the 40 files.

B. Start a new session without notes, so that no stale tool results can influence the analysis going forward.

C. Resume with --resume payments-investigation and tell Claude which 3 files changed, so it re-analyzes those without re-exploring the rest.

D. Start a fresh session with a structured summary of the earlier findings, then re-explore all 40 files to refresh the picture.

Question 2.8 · Multiple response · Select TWO Domain 3

A 900-line root CLAUDE.md in a monorepo with six packages mixes testing, API, and deployment standards. Each package's maintainers want to receive only the standards relevant to their package. Which TWO steps best restructure it? (Select TWO.)

A. Move package-specific standards into .claude/rules/ files with a paths field scoped to each package, such as packages/api/**.

B. Move each package's standards into the maintainers' ~/.claude/CLAUDE.md files, so that each person loads their own set.

C. Keep one file but add headers per package, and rely on Claude to infer which section applies to the current work.

D. Keep only the universal standards that every package needs in the root CLAUDE.md, trimmed to a short, focused file.

E. Move all standards into skills, which Claude then loads for every session in the repository without being asked.

Question 2.9 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 5

A coordinator and four subagents spent 90 minutes mapping a codebase before the host process crashed. Rerunning from scratch is too costly, and the subagents share no memory between invocations. Which design lets the work resume?

A. Each agent exports its state to a known location, and on restart the coordinator loads a manifest and injects that state into agent prompts.

B. Rerun only the coordinator and rely on each subagent to remember what it analyzed before the crash, so completed work is not repeated and only unfinished parts run again.

C. Store every subagent's raw conversation transcript and replay all of them into the coordinator's context when the system restarts after a crash.

D. Have the coordinator save its final synthesis at the end of the run, and restart from that file if a failure occurs.

Question 2.10 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 3

A 600-line CLAUDE.md includes universal code standards and a 120-line release checklist that matters only when cutting a release and needs the version number as input. The file is expensive to load in every session. What is the best change?

A. Move both the standards and the checklist into skills, so that nothing loads at the start of a session.

B. Move the checklist into a skill with an argument-hint for the version, and keep the universal standards in CLAUDE.md.

C. Move the checklist to ~/.claude/commands/ so that it is out of the repository's CLAUDE.md and out of every session.

D. Split the checklist into .claude/rules/ files without a paths field, so that each file is small and focused on one step.

SCENARIO 3

Multi-Agent Research System

A coordinator agent built on the Claude Agent SDK delegates to specialized subagents (web search, document analysis, synthesis, and report generation) to research topics and produce comprehensive, cited reports.

Question 3.1 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

A coordinator sends every query through search, document analysis, synthesis, and report generation. A simple question about a company's founding year takes 90 seconds and four subagent calls, while broad topic requests do benefit from the full pipeline. What change is best?

A. Cache the results of previous queries and return cached answers when similar queries arrive in the future.

B. Have the coordinator analyze each query's requirements and choose which subagents to invoke, using the full pipeline for broad topics.

C. Give the synthesis agent web search tools so that it can answer simple questions on its own without invoking the other agents in the pipeline each time.

D. Add a keyword filter in front of the coordinator that routes questions beginning with 'when' or 'who' to the search agent alone.

Question 3.2 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

In staging, a coordinator answers research questions by itself without delegating. In another configuration where delegation works, three independent subtopic searches run one per turn and take three times as long as expected. What changes fix both problems?

A. Add the Agent tool to each subagent's allowedTools, and give the coordinator a system prompt instruction to delegate more often and to wait for each result.

B. Raise the coordinator's token limit, and run each subtopic search in a separate session started in parallel by the user.

C. Include the Agent tool in the coordinator's allowedTools, and spawn one subagent per turn so each result is available before the next starts.

D. Include the Agent tool in the coordinator's allowedTools, and have it emit multiple Agent tool calls in a single response for independent subtopics.

Question 3.3 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 2

The document analysis subagent has 15 tools. Logs show it fetching arbitrary social media pages with a generic fetch_url tool and occasionally calling the report formatter. Which change gives the largest reliability gain?

A. Add a line to its system prompt telling it to fetch documents that are relevant to the research question.

B. Set tool_choice to any so that the subagent must call a tool, which keeps it from drifting into other behavior.

C. Restrict it to the 4 or 5 tools its role needs, replacing fetch_url with a load_document tool that validates document URLs.

D. Add five few-shot examples of correct fetches so that it learns which kinds of URLs should be loaded.

Question 3.4 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 5

One of five research sources stays unavailable after the subagent's local retries on timeouts. The other four produce useful findings. How should the system finish the run?

A. Proceed with partial results and structured error context, and have the synthesis annotate which findings are well supported and which topics have gaps.

B. Terminate the workflow and restart the entire run once all five sources are available again, so that every report is built from complete data on every topic.

C. Omit any mention of the missing source, so the final report reads as complete and avoids confusing readers with caveats.

D. Add a general disclaimer to each report stating that some sources may have been unavailable during research.

Question 3.5 · Multiple response · Select TWO Domain 1

The synthesis subagent produces fluent summaries but cites no sources and misses findings from the search and analysis subagents, because the coordinator invokes it with only the research topic. Which TWO changes fix this? (Select TWO.)

A. Rely on the synthesis subagent inheriting the coordinator's conversation history, and enable that through its tool configuration.

B. Include the complete findings from the prior agents directly in the synthesis subagent's prompt.

C. Pass findings as structured data that separates content from metadata such as source URLs, document names, and page numbers.

D. Store the previous findings in the synthesis AgentDefinition system prompt, so they exist when the subagent starts.

E. Replace the coordinator's goal-level instructions with a detailed step-by-step script for the synthesis subagent to follow.

Question 3.6 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 5

Two credible sources report AI adoption among firms: 38% from a 2023 survey of 1,200 firms, and 52% from a 2025 industry panel. The synthesis agent reported 52% and omitted the other figure, and a reviewer flagged the report as ignoring conflicting evidence. What is the best design?

A. Prefer the most recent figure and drop the older one, since newer data is more likely to be accurate and the report then stays short and clear.

B. Report the average of the two figures, with a note explaining that the underlying sources differ in their methods and in the year of collection.

C. Require dates and methodology in the claims, then present both values with attribution so readers can interpret the difference.

D. Remove statistics that conflict from the report and keep only the figures that several sources agree on, so the report reads as consistent.

Question 3.7 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 2

The search wrapper returns an empty list when the provider answers HTTP 429, and the coordinator then reports that no research exists on the topic. Which change corrects the behavior?

A. Keep returning an empty list for the 429 case but write the status to a log file so that the team can review the failures later.

B. Return a transient, retryable error with what was attempted and any partial results, and keep an empty success for queries that ran and found nothing.

C. Raise an exception from the wrapper that propagates to the top-level handler and ends the whole research run immediately, so that the failure is visible to everyone.

D. Retry five times inside the wrapper and return an empty list if all attempts fail, which keeps the wrapper's interface simple for the coordinator.

Question 3.8 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

About 20% of final reports omit an aspect of the topic. Subagents run correctly, and the coordinator's initial decomposition is usually reasonable but sometimes misses a branch. Which design best raises coverage?

A. Have the synthesis agent list gaps in an appendix so that readers know what was not covered by the research and can follow up themselves.

B. Run every subagent twice on each query and merge the results, which improves coverage through repeated sampling of the same sources.

C. Widen the search agent's first pass with more queries and broader terms, without changing how the coordinator decomposes the topic.

D. Have the coordinator check the synthesis for gaps, re-delegate targeted queries, and re-invoke synthesis until coverage is sufficient.

Question 3.9 · Multiple response · Select TWO Domain 2

The coordinator confuses analyze_content (used on web pages) and analyze_document (used on PDFs and reports); both carry near-identical descriptions, and the second handles extraction, summarization, and verification. Which TWO changes best reduce misrouting? (Select TWO.)

A. Merge both tools into one analyze tool that decides internally which kind of input it has received and what to do with it.

B. Prefix both descriptions with IMPORTANT and add a sentence urging careful tool selection whenever the request is ambiguous.

C. Add a system prompt rule that sends any request containing the word web to analyze_content, and every other request to analyze_document.

D. Rename analyze_content to extract_web_results and give it a description specific to web content, inputs, and outputs.

E. Split analyze_document into purpose-specific tools such as extract_data_points and verify_claim_against_source with defined contracts.

Question 3.10 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

Three search subagents return results in which 70% of sources overlap, which inflates cost and latency. Their prompts each say to research the topic thoroughly. What is the best fix?

A. Have the coordinator assign each subagent a distinct subtopic or source type before delegation.

B. Keep the assignments as they are and remove duplicates in the synthesis step, once all results have arrived.

C. Run the three subagents one after another, so that later ones can see what the earlier ones have found.

D. Tell each subagent to avoid sources that another subagent might also be using for the same topic.

SCENARIO 4

Developer Productivity with Claude

You are building developer productivity tooling on the Claude Agent SDK: helping engineers explore unfamiliar codebases, understand legacy systems, generate boilerplate, and automate repetitive tasks, using the built-in tools (Read, Write, Edit, Bash, Grep, Glob) plus MCP servers.

Question 4.1 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 2

You must find every consumer of legacyAuth.verify. Two wrapper modules re-export it as checkAuth and assertSession, and many callers use those names. Which approach finds all consumers with the least wasted effort?

A. Read the wrapper modules to list every exported name, then Grep for each name across the codebase.

B. Grep for legacyAuth.verify alone, since the wrappers re-export the same function under the same behavior.

C. Glob for files with auth in their names and Read each one, looking for calls to the function.

D. Read every source file up front, so that the complete picture is available before any searching begins.

Question 4.2 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

You are asked to add comprehensive tests to a 400-module legacy codebase with unknown structure and undocumented dependencies. Which approach fits best?

A. Chain fixed steps in alphabetical order, one module at a time, generating tests with identical instructions for each module.

B. Give one prompt that lists all modules and ask for tests across the entire codebase in a single pass.

C. Map the structure first, identify high-impact areas, then create a prioritized plan that adapts as dependencies are discovered.

D. Ask for tests for the modules with the lowest coverage first, and fix the resulting failures in one later session.

Question 4.3 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 2

The team wants a shared Jira integration for everyone, with each developer using their own token, and one developer wants to try an experimental database server without affecting teammates. What setup is best?

A. Place both servers in the project's .mcp.json so that everyone has the same tools, and let developers ignore the experimental one if they do not want it in their sessions.

B. Put a community Jira server in project-scoped .mcp.json with ${JIRA_TOKEN} expansion, and the experimental server in that developer's ~/.claude.json.

C. Put both servers in each developer's ~/.claude.json, and document the Jira setup steps in the repository's README.

D. Build a custom Jira MCP server for the team, and reference its token directly in .mcp.json for convenience.

Question 4.4 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

Despite a system prompt rule, an agent twice ran Bash commands that modified production config files. Policy allows no such modifications. Which fix provides the strongest guarantee?

A. Rewrite the rule in bold at the top of the system prompt, and repeat it before each tool call the agent makes during a run.

B. Add a PostToolUse hook that detects modified production files and reverts the changes after the command has run.

C. Add few-shot examples showing the agent declining to run commands that touch production config files, including a case with a plausible justification.

D. Add a hook on outgoing tool calls that blocks Bash commands targeting production config files and redirects to an approval workflow.

Question 4.5 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 3

Before adding a consumer to an event bus spanning 60 services, you explored it in the main session, and search output consumed 70% of the context window, leaving little room for implementation. How should the work be restructured?

A. Continue in the main session, and run /compact after discovery so that the output is condensed before the implementation phase.

B. Delegate discovery to an Explore subagent that returns a summary, plan the design in plan mode, then implement through direct execution.

C. Skip further exploration and begin implementing, then correct mistakes as the tests reveal them.

D. Split the work into two sessions and resume the first with --resume, so context from the exploration keeps accumulating.

Question 4.6 · Multiple response · Select TWO Domain 2

You must find where the message 'Payment declined: code 51' originates and understand how it propagates through a large codebase. Which TWO approaches are most effective? (Select TWO.)

A. Grep for the message string to find the places where it is raised.

B. Glob for **/*Payment* and treat the matching files as the places where the message is raised.

C. Read all files under src/ first, so that a full picture exists before any tracing begins.

D. Glob for test files that mention declines and trust their names to describe the code paths.

E. Read the matching files and follow imports step by step to trace the flow.

Question 4.7 · Multiple response · Select TWO Domain 1

After a three-hour analysis of an auth module, you want to compare two refactoring strategies from the same understanding, and tomorrow you will continue the named session auth-investigation after teammates change a few files. Which TWO actions are best? (Select TWO.)

A. Try strategy one, then strategy two, in the same session so each benefits from the other's context.

B. Use fork_session to create independent branches from the shared analysis baseline, one per strategy.

C. Start a new session each day without notes, because resuming sessions is unreliable.

D. Resume tomorrow with --resume auth-investigation and tell Claude which files changed, so it re-analyzes those.

E. Create the two branches as subagents of the current session, which share the session's memory between invocations.

Question 4.8 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 3

A developer wants a stricter personal version of the team's project skill /review, and wants it to prompt for a target branch when invoked without arguments, without affecting teammates. What is the best approach?

A. Create a personal skill under ~/.claude/skills/ with a different name, and add an argument-hint to its frontmatter.

B. Create ~/.claude/skills/review with the same name, so that the personal version replaces the team's version for that developer.

C. Edit .claude/skills/review/SKILL.md locally, add it to .gitignore, and leave the team's committed file unchanged.

D. Add the stricter checks to a section of the project CLAUDE.md, and select them with an argument when needed.

Question 4.9 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

A coordinator for a developer-productivity agent keeps sending documentation tasks to its test-writer subagent and test tasks to its doc-writer subagent. Each AgentDefinition has a name and the same set of tools. What is the best fix?

A. Give every subagent all available tools so that either can handle any task the coordinator sends.

B. Add keyword rules to the coordinator prompt that route messages with the word test or doc to the matching subagent.

C. Invoke both subagents for each request and merge their answers in the coordinator.

D. Give each AgentDefinition a precise description, a focused system prompt, and tool restrictions matching its role.

Question 4.10 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

An agent calls Grep for 'TODO(auth)'. Your code runs it and prints the matches to the console, then sends the next request containing the user's message and the assistant's tool_use turn. The agent calls the same Grep again, repeatedly. What is the root cause and fix?

A. The model's max_tokens is too low to process the results, so raise it until the model can finish its answer without being cut off.

B. The loop has no iteration limit, so add a cap of ten iterations and stop the loop when that cap is reached during a run.

C. The tool result was not added to the history, so append a result block that references the call before the next request.

D. The model is repeating itself because tool_choice is auto, so force the Grep tool for the next request to focus its behavior.

SCENARIO 5

Claude Code for Continuous Integration

You are integrating Claude Code into a CI/CD pipeline for automated code review, test generation, and pull-request feedback, designing prompts that produce actionable findings while minimizing false positives.

Question 5.1 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 3

A CI step runs claude -p with a review prompt and --output-format json, but the script that posts inline PR comments fails because the findings do not match the expected structure. Which change is most appropriate?

A. Add a sentence to the prompt telling Claude to respond with JSON matching the expected structure and nothing else.

B. Parse the output with a regular expression that extracts the first JSON-looking block from the returned text.

C. Rely on --output-format json alone, since it enforces the structure of the individual findings in the output.

D. Add --json-schema with a findings schema alongside --output-format json, so that output is machine-parseable and shaped as expected.

Question 5.2 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 4

A review bot reports many minor style comments and local-pattern nitpicks. Developers have started ignoring all of its comments, including accurate security findings. What is the best response?

A. Define explicit categories to report (bugs, security) and to skip (minor style, local patterns), and pause the noisy categories while you refine them.

B. Add an instruction to be conservative and report only high-confidence findings in every review that the bot runs on pull requests.

C. Have the model rate its confidence for each finding and discard those below a threshold that the team chooses after reviewing sample output.

D. Run the review three times and post only the findings that appear in at least two of the runs, which filters out one-off comments.

Question 5.3 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 4

A nightly audit of newly merged code must deliver results within 36 hours of a merge. Message Batches API jobs can take up to 24 hours with no guaranteed latency. How often should batches be submitted to meet the SLA?

A. Every 24 hours, since each batch finishes within 24 hours and the audit then completes within that window.

B. Every 14 hours, which gives frequent coverage while leaving the batch processing window intact for each job.

C. Every 6 hours, so that waiting time before submission plus the 24-hour processing window stays within 36 hours.

D. As each merge occurs, relying on batches usually finishing well before the 24-hour limit is reached.

Question 5.4 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 3

After each new commit, the CI review re-runs and posts comments on issues already reported on earlier commits, which developers have started ignoring. What is the best change?

A. Delete every earlier review comment before each run, and post the complete set of findings again.

B. Include the prior review findings in context and instruct Claude to report only new issues or ones that remain unaddressed.

C. Compare comment text with a hash after generation and skip any exact duplicate before posting it.

D. Run the review on the final commit of each pull request, and ignore the intermediate commits.

Question 5.5 · Multiple response · Select TWO Domain 4

The same Claude session writes code and then reviews it, and its reviews rarely find problems that human reviewers later catch. Which TWO changes improve defect detection? (Select TWO.)

A. Turn on extended thinking in the same session and instruct it to review its own code critically before it reports findings.

B. Tell the session at the start of the review to assume the code contains at least three bugs.

C. Use a second, independent Claude instance without the generator's reasoning context to review the code.

D. Re-run the review later in the same session, after /compact has condensed the context of the earlier generation work.

E. Split the review into a focused pass on each file for local defects plus a separate cross-file integration pass, run by the independent instance.

Question 5.6 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 4

Review comments arrive in inconsistent formats, some lacking severity or location, and the bot flags acceptable local patterns as issues even though the prompt contains detailed prose rules. Which change addresses both problems?

A. Extend the prose rules with more detailed descriptions of each severity level, each acceptable pattern, and the exact order of the fields.

B. Add a JSON schema requiring location, issue, severity, and fix, and leave the judgment criteria in the prompt unchanged by the schema.

C. Lower the sampling temperature, so the model follows the existing instructions more consistently across runs and across files.

D. Add 2 to 4 few-shot examples showing the format (location, issue, severity, fix) and acceptable patterns versus genuine issues.

Question 5.7 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 1

The team has two Claude Code jobs: (1) a per-PR review covering the same four aspects on 20 to 25 files, which shows attention dilution and contradictory comments, and (2) a weekly investigation of intermittent test failures with an unknown cause. How should each be decomposed?

A. Use a dynamic adaptive plan for both jobs, since each run involves different files, different findings, and different amounts of context to examine.

B. Use a fixed prompt chain for both jobs, since fixed chains give repeatable and auditable behavior and are easier to debug in production.

C. Use per-file passes plus a cross-file integration pass for the review, and an adaptive, findings-driven plan for the investigation.

D. Use a dynamic plan for the review, and a fixed chain of lint, unit test, and integration test steps for the investigation of failures.

Question 5.8 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 4

Developers dismiss about 30% of the review findings posted as inline comments. The team wants to find out systematically which kinds of code trigger the dismissed findings. What should be added to the output?

A. A detected_pattern field in each finding recording the code construct that triggered it, so dismissals can be analyzed by pattern.

B. A severity field only, since dismissals correlate with low severity and that correlation will explain the pattern across pull requests.

C. A free-text field in which developers type why they dismissed the finding, collected and read once each month by the team.

D. A count of total findings per pull request, which will show whether the volume of findings predicts dismissal by developers.

Question 5.9 · Multiple response · Select TWO Domain 3

A CI job generates unit tests, but many are trivial or duplicate scenarios the suite already covers. Which TWO changes improve the output? (Select TWO.)

A. Document testing standards, criteria for valuable tests, and available fixtures in CLAUDE.md for the CI-invoked session.

B. Provide the existing test files in context so generation avoids suggesting scenarios the suite already covers.

C. Remove the -p flag so that Claude can ask clarifying questions about which tests are valuable before it generates them.

D. Add --output-format json, which improves the quality of the generated tests by giving them a consistent structure.

E. Generate the tests in the same session that wrote the code, so that it knows the implementation details and design intent.

Question 5.10 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 4

The same string-concatenated SQL query is labeled critical in one PR and medium in another. The prompt says to classify severity sensibly. What should change?

A. Tell the model to keep its severity labels consistent across all of the reviews it performs.

B. Define explicit severity criteria with a concrete code example for each severity level.

C. Drop low-confidence findings so that only the most certain labels are posted to the pull request.

D. Add a post-processing script that rewrites severity labels using a table keyed by finding title.

SCENARIO 6

Structured Data Extraction

You are building a structured data extraction system: pulling information from unstructured documents, validating output against JSON schemas, handling edge cases gracefully, and integrating with downstream systems.

Question 6.1 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 4

Incoming documents may be invoices, receipts, or contracts, each with its own extraction tool and schema, and the type is unknown when the call is made. With tool_choice set to auto, about 6% of responses come back as conversational text. What is the best change?

A. Force the invoice extraction tool, which covers most documents, and leave fields null where they do not apply.

B. Keep auto and add a system prompt instruction to respond with an extraction tool call rather than text.

C. Set tool_choice to any, so the model must call one of the extraction tools and can choose the matching one.

D. Ask for JSON in the prompt text and parse the response, instead of using tools for extraction.

Question 6.2 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 4

A validation-retry loop appends the specific validation errors and retries up to three times. Retries fix date-format mismatches, but 8% of documents still fail on required field po_number, which appears only in a purchase order that was never provided. What should change?

A. Increase the retry limit to six for every error type, so persistent cases get more opportunities to succeed before they are flagged.

B. Strengthen the prompt, stating that po_number must be found and that the answer cannot be left empty under any circumstances.

C. Make the model return a best-guess po_number from nearby text, flagged for review by a person before the data is used downstream.

D. Retry format and structural failures with the specific errors, but stop when the information is absent and route those to review or return null.

Question 6.3 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 5

Extraction accuracy is 97% overall on the validation set. The team wants to auto-accept high-confidence extractions and cut human review by 80%. Which step should come first?

A. Proceed, since 97% exceeds the team's 95% target and human review capacity is limited and costly.

B. Measure accuracy by document type and by field to confirm consistent performance before reducing review.

C. Increase the validation set size, and recompute the overall accuracy with a tighter confidence interval around the estimate.

D. Average the model's self-reported confidence across the set, and set the acceptance threshold at that average for all fields.

Question 6.4 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 4

The schema requires vat_number, and for receipts that show no VAT number the model returns plausible-looking invented values. The output passes schema validation. What is the best change?

A. Make vat_number optional and nullable, so the model can return null when the document does not contain it.

B. Add strict mode to the schema, which prevents the model from outputting values that are not in the document.

C. Add an instruction to double-check each required field against the document before answering.

D. Add few-shot examples of receipts with a VAT number, so the model learns what real ones look like.

Question 6.5 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 2

Each document must first go through extract_metadata (document type and language) before enrichment tools run. Occasionally the model calls an enrichment tool first, producing results that assume the wrong language. Which configuration fixes this?

A. Set tool_choice to any so the model must call a tool, which keeps it from skipping straight to enrichment.

B. Keep tool_choice at auto and state in the system prompt that extract_metadata comes first.

C. Force extract_metadata on every request in the conversation so that the metadata is refreshed on each turn.

D. Force extract_metadata on the first request, then handle enrichment in follow-up turns.

Question 6.6 · Multiple response · Select TWO Domain 4

A batch of 100 documents completes with 7 failures caused by documents exceeding context limits. The team will run similar batches weekly. Which TWO actions are best? (Select TWO.)

A. Resubmit the entire batch, so that all results come from the same run and the output is consistent across documents.

B. Move the weekly job to the synchronous API for all documents, because batch processing cannot handle failures.

C. Resubmit only the failed documents identified by custom_id, after modifying them, such as chunking those that exceeded limits.

D. Refine the prompt on a small sample before large batches, to improve first-pass success and reduce resubmissions.

E. Have the batch requests fetch missing context through multi-turn tool calls during processing, so oversized documents succeed.

Question 6.7 · Multiple choice · Select ONE Domain 5

After launch, high-confidence extractions skip human review. The team wants to keep measuring the error rate in that stream and detect new error patterns. Which practice fits?

A. Stratified random sampling of the high-confidence extractions, across document types and fields, reviewed by humans on an ongoing basis.

B. Review the low-confidence extractions, since those carry the highest error risk, and leave the rest unreviewed.

C. Review the first 1% of each day's high-confidence extractions, selected by arrival order.

D. Trust the calibrated confidence scores and re-calibrate once a year against a fresh labeled set.

Question 6.8 · Multiple choice · Select ONE

Domain 4

Extractions return null for methodology when it is described in narrative text rather than under a methodology heading, and miss citations when they are inline instead of in a bibliography. Detailed instructions did not help. What is the most effective change?

A. Make methodology and citations required fields, so the model searches harder before returning an answer for each document.

B. Add an instruction to search the entire document carefully and not to stop at section headings when looking for fields.

C. Add few-shot examples of correct extraction from varied structures, including inline citations and embedded methodology.

D. Increase max_tokens so the model has room to reason about where the information might be found in the document.

Question 6.9 · Multiple choice · Select ONE

Domain 4

In 4% of extractions, the line items do not sum to the invoice total even though the output passes schema validation. What should be added?

A. Switch to strict mode for the schema, which prevents inconsistent values from appearing in the extraction output for any invoice.

B. Extract calculated_total alongside stated_total and flag discrepancies, with a conflict_detected flag for inconsistent source data.

C. Force the extraction tool with tool_choice so that the model produces consistent totals for each invoice that it reads.

D. Add more few-shot examples of invoices with correct totals to the extraction prompt, covering different layouts and vendors.

Question 6.10 · Multiple choice · Select ONE

Domain 5

A synthesis step receives findings from 12 documents concatenated into one input. Reports consistently omit findings from documents 5 to 8, while documents at the beginning and end are well covered. What is the best fix?

A. Move to a model with a larger context window, so that the middle of the input is processed as reliably.

B. Shuffle the document order randomly on each run so that omissions average out across runs.

C. Instruct the model to be thorough and to cover every document in its answer.

D. Place a summary of key findings at the beginning and organize the detailed results with explicit section headers.

Answer key

1.1	**C**	1.2	**A**	1.3	**D**	1.4	**B**	1.5	**A, C**	1.6	**A**
1.7	**D**	1.8	**B**	1.9	**B, E**	1.10	**C**	2.1	**D**	2.2	**B**
2.3	**A**	2.4	**C**	2.5	**D**	2.6	**C, E**	2.7	**C**	2.8	**A, D**
2.9	**A**	2.10	**B**	3.1	**B**	3.2	**D**	3.3	**C**	3.4	**A**
3.5	**B, C**	3.6	**C**	3.7	**B**	3.8	**D**	3.9	**D, E**	3.10	**A**
4.1	**A**	4.2	**C**	4.3	**B**	4.4	**D**	4.5	**B**	4.6	**A, E**
4.7	**B, D**	4.8	**A**	4.9	**D**	4.10	**C**	5.1	**D**	5.2	**A**
5.3	**C**	5.4	**B**	5.5	**C, E**	5.6	**D**	5.7	**C**	5.8	**A**
5.9	**A, B**	5.10	**B**	6.1	**C**	6.2	**D**	6.3	**B**	6.4	**A**
6.5	**D**	6.6	**C, D**	6.7	**A**	6.8	**C**	6.9	**B**	6.10	**D**

Answers and rationales

1.1 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 1.4 — Domain 1

A programmatic gate gives the deterministic guarantee that financial operations require, and binding the ID to the value get_customer returned closes the gap that merely checking whether get_customer ran would leave. A and B depend on probabilistic compliance, which has a non-zero failure rate. D only controls the first turn: it does not bind later calls to the verified ID, and it fails when a conversation opens without an identifier.

1.2 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 2.2 — Domain 2

A valid empty result is a successful query with no matches, while a timeout is an access failure that needs a retry decision, so each must be reported differently with structured metadata. B pushes interpretation of message strings into the prompt, which is fragile. C is a blunt cap that abandons transient failures that would have succeeded. D mislabels a timeout as a business error and treats a valid empty result as a failure, so real transient problems are not retried and valid empty results are escalated.

1.3 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 5.2 — Domain 5

Multiple matches call for clarification with an additional identifier, not heuristic selection, and the agent can acknowledge frustration while still resolving the case. A picks by recency, a heuristic that selects the wrong account some of the time and discloses another person's order details when wrong. B treats sentiment as a proxy for complexity, which it is not, and adds to escalation load. C relies on self-reported confidence, which is poorly calibrated.

1.4 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 1.5 Domain 1

A PostToolUse hook transforms results before the model processes them, which fixes the format problem, and an interception hook on outgoing calls enforces the $500 limit before the refund executes. A checks the amount only after process_refund has returned, so the refund has already been processed. C normalizes arguments rather than results, so the format problem persists, and leaves the policy in a description the model may not follow. D relies on probabilistic compliance for both needs.

1.5 **Answer: A, C** Exam guide task statement 2.2 Domain 2

A policy violation is a business error: non-retryable, paired with an explanation the agent can relay. A transient timeout is retryable, and the metadata tells the agent where retries are worth spending. B exposes internals the agent cannot use. D moves interpretation into fragile prompt text instead of structured metadata. E is a blunt cap that still wastes an attempt on non-retryable errors and abandons transient failures too early.

1.6 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 1.1 Domain 1

Model-driven decisions let Claude pick the next tool from accumulated results and adapt to ticket types that do not fit the sequence, while a programmatic prerequisite preserves the deterministic identity check. B grows a brittle tree that needs a branch per new type. C is still a pre-configured sequence with extra logic. D removes the model from reasoning over intermediate results, so it cannot adapt when a tool returns something unexpected.

1.7 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 5.1 Domain 5

Transactional facts and per-issue data belong in a persistent structured layer included in each prompt outside the summarized history, so summarization cannot blur them. A only delays the loss. B still relies on a prose summary to preserve number-to-order mappings. C lets tool outputs, which carry many irrelevant fields, consume tokens and does not scale.

1.8 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 2.3 Domain 2

Too many tools (the guide contrasts 18 with 4 or 5) degrade selection by increasing decision complexity, so scoping tools to the role is the strongest lever. A improves discrimination between similar tools but leaves the complexity in place. C forces a tool call on every turn, which does not improve which tool is chosen and prevents a final text reply. D creates generic tools, the opposite of the purpose-specific tools the guide recommends.

1.9 **Answer: B, E** Exam guide task statement 1.4 Domain 1

Multi-concern messages are decomposed and answered with one unified resolution, and an escalation for a human who lacks the transcript needs a structured handoff summary with customer ID, root cause analysis, amounts, and a recommended action. A discards work within the agent's capability. C dumps unprocessed noise and leaves the analysis to the human. D forces the customer to repeat a request already made.

1.10 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 2.1 Domain 2

A keyword-sensitive instruction in the system prompt created an unintended tool association that overrides well-written descriptions, so the instruction itself must be reworded around intent and re-tested. A and B add information that was not the cause, and B adds token overhead. D adds a routing layer that bypasses the model's language understanding and is disproportionate to a wording problem.

2.1 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 3.1 Domain 3

/context lists the memory files that actually loaded (/memory lists and opens memory file locations), and an @import is the mechanism that pulls an external file into a package's CLAUDE.md, which loads when Claude works on files in packages/api. A plain-text path is not an import, so Claude never sees the file. A bloats the root file so every package gets standards it does not need. B puts shared standards in user-level files, which are not shared through version control. C uses an on-demand mechanism for standards that should apply to that package without anyone invoking them.

2.2 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 3.3 Domain 3

A path-scoped rule with a glob loads when matching files are edited, regardless of directory, which also saves tokens. A is directory-bound and needs 30 files to maintain. C loads the content in every session. D relies on manual invocation, which does not give automatic application by file path.

2.3 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 3.2 Domain 3

context: fork runs the skill in a subagent whose output stays out of the main conversation, and the agent field picks that subagent's type, so a read-only type removes write tools. B is wrong because allowed-tools only pre-approves the listed tools for the turn; per the docs it 'does not restrict which tools are available', and the output still lands in the main session. C isolates output, but the default general-purpose subagent keeps write tools. D prompts for parameters and neither isolates output nor restricts tools.

2.4 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 5.4 Domain 5

Context degradation, shown by generic 'typical patterns' replacing specifics, is countered by scratchpad files that persist key findings, subagents that isolate verbose exploration, and /compact when discovery output fills context. A reloads files at high token cost and does not scale. B misreads the problem, since a larger window does not fix attention quality. D is an instruction that cannot restore specifics that are no longer being attended to.

2.5 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 3.4 Domain 3

Plan mode suits architectural decisions and multi-file changes (tasks 2 and 4), and direct execution suits well-scoped fixes (tasks 1 and 3); combining planning for investigation with direct execution for implementation fits the migration. A adds overhead to simple tasks. B defers planning for a migration whose complexity is already known. C reverses the logic: task 1 is a simple fix, and task 4 is exactly an architectural decision between approaches.

2.6 **Answer: C, E** Exam guide task statement 3.5 Domain 3

Concrete input and output examples, including a null case, resolve prose that is interpreted inconsistently, and interacting issues are best described together in one message. A repeats the prose that already failed. B isolates fixes that interact. D inverts test-driven iteration, which writes tests first and iterates on failures.

2.7 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 1.7 Domain 1

Most of the prior context is still valid (37 of 40 files unchanged), so resuming the named session and reporting the changed files supports targeted re-analysis. A ignores the stale results for the 3 changed files. B discards valid work. D is the right pattern when most prior tool results are stale, not when only a few are, and it wastes effort on re-exploration.

2.8 **Answer: A, D** Exam guide task statement 3.1, 3.3 Domain 3

Path-scoped rules load only when Claude works on matching files, so each package receives only its own standards, and the root CLAUDE.md keeps the universal content every session needs (the docs target under 200 lines). B uses user-level files, which are not shared through version control. C relies on inference rather than explicit loading. E misuses skills, which are invoked on demand rather than loaded for every session. Note that rules without a paths field load unconditionally, and @imports load with the file that imports them, so neither reduces context cost on its own.

2.9 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 5.4 Domain 5

Structured state exports to a known location and a manifest loaded on resume let the coordinator inject state into agent prompts. B assumes subagents keep memory between invocations, which they do not. C replays bulky transcripts, which wastes context. D saves only the end result, so a crash mid-run still loses 90 minutes of intermediate work.

2.10 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 3.2 Domain 3

Skills are on-demand for task-specific workflows, with argument-hint prompting for the version, while universal standards belong in the always-loaded CLAUDE.md. A removes universal standards from always-loaded context. C makes the checklist personal, so teammates do not get it. D keeps unscoped rules, which do not load conditionally because they have no paths field.

3.1 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 1.2 Domain 1

The coordinator should analyze the query and dynamically select which subagents to invoke instead of running the full pipeline each time. A treats the symptom for repeat queries only. C over-provisions the synthesis agent with tools outside its role. D substitutes a brittle keyword heuristic for the coordinator's judgment.

3.2 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 1.3 Domain 1

The coordinator needs the Agent tool (named Task before Claude Code v2.1.63, and still listed as Task in the system:init tools list) in its allowedTools to spawn subagents, and parallel spawning is done by emitting multiple Agent calls in a single response. A grants the tool to the wrong agents. B splits work across sessions manually and does not address the coordinator configuration. C keeps sequential spawning, which is what causes the latency.

3.3 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 2.3 Domain 2

Restricting a subagent to role-relevant tools and replacing a generic tool with a constrained one removes the opportunity for misuse. A and D depend on probabilistic behavior and keep the misuse path open. B forces a tool call but does not constrain which tool is called.

3.4 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 5.3 Domain 5

Structured error context lets the coordinator proceed with partial results, and coverage annotations show which findings are well supported and where gaps remain. B terminates the whole workflow on a single failure. C hides the gap and risks misleading readers. D is a generic note that gives no information about which topics are affected.

3.5 **Answer: B, C** Exam guide task statement 1.3 Domain 1

Subagents do not inherit the coordinator's context, so complete prior findings must be in the prompt, and structured data that separates content from metadata preserves attribution. A assumes inheritance that does not exist. D fixes static content into the definition, which cannot carry findings from the current run. E replaces goal-level guidance with procedure, which reduces adaptability.

3.6 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 5.6 Domain 5

Conflicting statistics should be annotated with source attribution instead of arbitrarily selected, and dates and methodology prevent a temporal difference from being read as a contradiction. A picks one value arbitrarily. B invents a figure that neither source reports. D drops information that readers need.

3.7 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 2.2 Domain 2

An access failure such as a rate limit must be distinguishable from a valid empty result, and a transient, retryable error with partial results lets the coordinator decide what to do. A suppresses the error as success. C terminates everything on one failure. D hides the failure behind an empty success after retries.

3.8 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 1.2 Domain 1

An iterative refinement loop, where the coordinator evaluates gaps and re-delegates targeted queries until coverage suffices, addresses the missed branch. A reports the gap without filling it. B doubles cost without targeting the gap. C improves one agent's breadth but not the coordinator's decomposition.

3.9 **Answer: D, E** Exam guide task statement 2.1 Domain 2

Renaming to remove functional overlap and splitting a generic tool into purpose-specific ones with defined contracts remove the ambiguity. A consolidates into a generic tool. B adds emphasis without discrimination. C adds a keyword-sensitive instruction that creates unintended tool associations.

3.10 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 1.2 Domain 1

Partitioning scope by distinct subtopic or source type minimizes duplication. B pays for the duplication and removes it afterward. C adds latency and still leaves each agent's scope undefined. D asks for coordination that isolated subagents cannot perform, since they cannot see one another's sources.

4.1 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 2.5 Domain 2

Tracing usage across wrapper modules means identifying all exported names first, then searching for each name with Grep. B misses callers that use the re-exported names. C searches by file name, not content. D reads everything upfront instead of building understanding incrementally.

4.2 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 1.6 Domain 1

Open-ended tasks call for mapping the structure, identifying high-impact areas, and a prioritized plan that adapts as dependencies appear. A is a fixed chain that ignores dependencies and impact. B overloads a single pass. D skips mapping, so order is driven by coverage alone and failures are deferred.

4.3 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 2.4 Domain 2

Shared tooling belongs in project-scoped .mcp.json with environment variable expansion for the token, personal or experimental servers in user-scoped ~/.claude.json, and a community server suits a standard integration. A pushes a personal server onto teammates. C leaves shared tooling to manual setup. D builds custom where a community server fits and places a secret in a committed file.

4.4 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 1.5 Domain 1

A hook on outgoing tool calls enforces the compliance rule deterministically before the command runs. A and C depend on probabilistic compliance. B acts after the modification has happened, so the violation still occurs.

4.5 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 3.4 Domain 3

The Explore subagent isolates verbose discovery and returns a summary, plan mode supports the design phase, and direct execution implements it. A condenses output only after the context has been consumed. C skips discovery for a change with architectural implications. D keeps accumulating exploration context in the same thread.

4.6 **Answer: A, E** Exam guide task statement 2.5 Domain 2

Grep searches content for strings such as error messages, and tracing flows is done incrementally by reading matches and following imports. B uses Glob, which matches file names, not content. C reads everything upfront. D trusts file names for behavior.

4.7 **Answer: B, D** Exam guide task statement 1.7 Domain 1

fork_session creates independent branches from a shared baseline, and resuming a named session with a note on changed files supports targeted re-analysis. A lets one strategy contaminate the other. C discards valid context. E is wrong because subagents do not share memory between invocations.

4.8 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 3.2 Domain 3

Personal variants go in ~/.claude/skills/ under a different name, and argument-hint shows the expected argument during autocomplete. B is not ambiguous: personal skills take precedence over project skills with the same name, so /review would run the personal version, but that hides the team's /review from this developer. C diverges from the team's committed file through local edits. D uses always-loaded context for an on-demand workflow.

4.9 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 1.3 Domain 1

AgentDefinition configuration comprises a description, system prompt, and tool restrictions, which together define each subagent's role and let the coordinator route correctly. A removes specialization and invites misuse. B uses keyword routing in place of the coordinator's judgment from descriptions. C wastes work and defeats selection.

4.10 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 1.1 Domain 1

The model can reason about tool output only if the tool result is appended to the conversation history before the next request. A and B treat symptoms, and an iteration cap is not the primary fix. D forces more of the same call.

5.1 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 3.6 Domain 3

--output-format json with --json-schema produces machine-parseable structured findings. A is a prompt-only request that does not enforce structure. B is fragile parsing. C is wrong because --output-format json alone does not enforce a findings schema.

5.2 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 4.1 Domain 4

Explicit categorical criteria beat vague instructions, and temporarily disabling noisy categories protects developer trust while prompts improve. B and C use general or confidence-based filtering, which the guide says fails to improve precision. D suppresses real bugs that appear intermittently.

5.3 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 4.5 Domain 4

The worst-case wait before submission plus the 24-hour batch window must fit within the SLA: 6 + 24 = 30 hours is within 36. 24 + 24 = 48 and 14 + 24 = 38 both exceed it. D relies on batches finishing early, but there is no guaranteed latency SLA.

5.4 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 3.6 Domain 3

Providing prior findings and instructing Claude to report only new or still-unaddressed issues avoids duplicates. A re-posts everything. C misses reworded duplicates. D delays feedback and loses coverage of intermediate commits.

5.5 **Answer: C, E** Exam guide task statement 4.6 Domain 4

A second independent instance without the generator's reasoning context catches subtle issues better than self-review, and splitting the review into per-file local passes plus a cross-file integration pass avoids attention dilution and contradictory findings. A is self-review with extended thinking, which independent instances outperform. B adds a self-review instruction with the same limitation. D stays in the same session, so the review is still not independent.

5.6 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 4.2 Domain 4

Few-shot examples are the most effective way to get consistent format and to teach the model to generalize judgment, including acceptable versus genuine issues. A extends prose that already underperforms. B fixes format but not judgment. C does not address either problem.

5.7 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 1.6 Domain 1

Prompt chaining suits predictable multi-aspect reviews, with per-file local passes and a cross-file integration pass to avoid attention dilution, while dynamic decomposition suits open-ended investigation. A, B, and D apply the wrong pattern to at least one job.

5.8 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 4.4 Domain 4

A detected_pattern field tracks which constructs trigger findings, enabling systematic analysis of dismissal patterns. B, C, and D do not record the construct, so grouping dismissals by code type is not possible.

5.9 **Answer: A, B** Exam guide task statement 3.6 Domain 3

CLAUDE.md supplies testing standards, valuable test criteria, and fixtures, and existing test files in context prevent duplicate scenarios. C removes -p, which makes the job hang waiting for interactive input. D changes the output format, not test value. E relies on the generating session, which is less effective at independent judgment.

5.10 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 4.1 Domain 4

Explicit severity criteria with concrete code examples per level give consistent classification. A is a vague instruction. C filters rather than classifies. D patches labels by title, which cannot distinguish how the same title differs across contexts.

6.1 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 4.3 Domain 4

tool_choice any guarantees a tool call while letting the model pick the matching schema when the document type is unknown. A forces one schema regardless of type. B depends on prompt compliance and leaves auto in place. D gives up schema-enforced tool output, reintroducing syntax errors.

6.2 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 4.4 Domain 4

Retry with specific errors works for format and structural failures but is ineffective when the information is absent from the source. A and B spend more effort on cases where retry cannot succeed. C fabricates a value.

6.3 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 5.5 Domain 5

Aggregate accuracy can mask weak document types or fields, so segment accuracy must be verified before reducing review. A trusts the aggregate. C refines the aggregate without segmentation. D uses an uncalibrated confidence average.

6.4 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 4.3 Domain 4

Optional and nullable fields stop the model from fabricating values to satisfy required fields. B is wrong because strict mode eliminates syntax errors but not semantic ones. C and D leave the incentive to fabricate in place.

6.5 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 2.3 Domain 2

Forced tool selection on the first request guarantees extract_metadata runs first, and later steps proceed in follow-up turns. A guarantees some tool call, not which one. B is probabilistic. C would force the same tool on every turn, so the workflow could never move on to enrichment.

6.6 **Answer: C, D** Exam guide task statement 4.5 Domain 4

Failures are identified by custom_id and resubmitted with modifications, and refining the prompt on a sample first improves first-pass success. A repeats work that succeeded. B overstates the limitation and gives up the batch cost savings. E is wrong because batch requests cannot execute tools mid-request.

6.7 **Answer: A** Exam guide task statement 5.5 Domain 5

Stratified random sampling of high-confidence extractions measures error rates and detects novel patterns across segments. B leaves the auto-accepted stream unmeasured. C samples by arrival order, which does not represent segments. D lacks ongoing validation.

6.8 **Answer: C** Exam guide task statement 4.2 Domain 4

Few-shot examples covering varied document structures address empty or null extraction of fields and help generalization. A makes fields required, which risks fabrication. B and D restate effort without demonstrating the structures.

6.9 **Answer: B** Exam guide task statement 4.4 Domain 4

Schema validation catches syntax errors, but semantic errors such as totals that do not sum need calculated_total next to stated_total and conflict flags. A is wrong because strict mode does not catch semantic errors. C controls which tool is called, not value consistency. D is partial, since examples cannot guarantee arithmetic consistency.

6.10 **Answer: D** Exam guide task statement 5.1 Domain 5

Position effects are mitigated by placing key findings summaries at the beginning and using explicit section headers. A is wrong because larger windows do not fix the lost-in-the-middle effect. B randomizes rather than fixes. C is an instruction that does not change how the model processes the middle of long inputs.

How did you do?

If this set helped your CCAR-F preparation, pass it on to someone else who is preparing. Good luck on exam day.

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